

NEXUS EOC User Guide

Player Handbook

A practical guide for setting up Solo and Team Exercises, using the live workspace, writing useful responses, coordinating with other players, and reviewing exercise outputs.

WHAT NEXUS EOC IS

NEXUS EOC is an interactive emergency operations training platform. It is not a multiple-choice quiz. The scenario changes in response to what the player or team actually writes - including priorities, assignments, information requests, resource decisions, and coordination choices.

The basic exercise cycle

1. Select or build an exercise: choose a prebuilt scenario, localize it to a real jurisdiction, or build a custom exercise.
2. Configure the run: select position/function, difficulty, and Solo or Team mode.
3. Read and respond: review the incident picture and submit EOC-level direction.
4. Adapt: NEXUS updates the scenario based on the decisions and gaps it identifies.
5. Review: end the exercise and use the AAR and transcript to identify lessons.

A strong response includes

- Priorities: life safety, stabilization, continuity, and what matters first.
- Ownership: who is responsible - a section, ESF, agency, or named staff function.
- Resources: what is needed, where it is needed, and why.
- Information gaps: what must be confirmed and who will confirm it.
- Next action: what should happen now while uncertainty is managed.

PLAYER MINDSET

Write like you are working in an EOC. Clear operational direction is more valuable than polished prose. Ask questions, assign responsibility, and keep the operation moving while information is still incomplete.

Starting a Solo Exercise

Prebuilt or localized scenarios

CONFIGURE MISSION

Start Exercise

Select the incident, operating role, jurisdiction, and difficulty profile before launching the live exercise dashboard.

SELECT SCENARIO

FILTER: All



Hurricane Landfall
Coastal hurricane impacts with evacuation, sheltering, infrastructure, and resource-prioritization pressures.
NATURAL HAZARD



Mass Casualty Incident
High-casualty incident requiring rapid coordination across EMS, hospitals, law enforcement, and public information.
MCI



Hazardous Materials Release
HazMat incident with protective actions, public warning, environmental monitoring, and multiagency coordination.
HAZMAT



Cyber-Infrastructure Cascade
Cyber disruption affecting water, power, communications, public services, and continuity of operations.
INFRASTRUCTURE



Major Earthquake
Seismic event with damage assessment gaps, degraded communications, medical surge, and resource staging challenges.
NATURAL HAZARD



Flash Flood / Dam Failure
Rapid flooding with downstream warning, evacuations, sheltering, access constraints, and infrastructure risk.
NATURAL HAZARD



Urban Wildfire
Wind-driven fire with evacuation routes, shelter options, air resource coordination, and structure exposure risk.
NATURAL HAZARD



Winter Storm Cascade
Extreme winter impacts with power outages, road clearance, warming shelters, fuel, and vulnerable populations.
NATURAL HAZARD



Radiological Dispersal Device
RDD event requiring consequence management, public messaging, federal coordination, and contamination controls.
SECURITY / CBRN



Train Derailment — MCI / HazMat
Rail incident combining casualties, hazardous materials, evacuation decisions, and railroad coordination.



Build Custom Scenario
Create a guided EOC exercise using your own real-world location, event, and training focus.

CONFIRM YOUR SCENARIO

Radiological Dispersal Device

RDD event requiring consequence management, public messaging, federal coordination, and contamination controls.

SECURITY / CBRN

PARTICIPANT
Not provided

POSITION / FUNCTION
EOC Director

FUNCTIONAL FOCUS
You are the EOC Director — the senior emergency manager responsible for overall coordination, resource prioritization, and strategic decision-making across all sections and ESFs.

JURISDICTION CONTEXT
Tribal Nation

A federally recognized tribal nation or tribal jurisdiction with sovereign authority, tribal emergency management responsibilities, federal coordination requirements, and distinct legal, political, cultural, and geographic considerations.

Constraints: Sovereign jurisdiction, BIA/IHS/federal coordination, limited local tax base, possible geographic isolation, trust land boundaries, mutual aid complexity, communications gaps, and culturally appropriate public messaging needs.

DIFFICULTY PROFILE
Adaptive — The AI adjusts difficulty based on the participant's performance.

RESPONSE GUIDANCE

Give clear operational direction. Identify who is responsible, what information you need, what resources are required, and what priority decisions must be made next.

Start Exercise screen: scenario library, role, jurisdiction, difficulty, and confirmation panel.

Path 1 - Use a prebuilt scenario

1. Select a scenario card and review its summary in the right-side panel.
2. Choose the position/function you want to train.
3. Select the difficulty level. Adaptive changes pressure based on performance.
4. Review the setup, then select Start Exercise.

Using a Real Jurisdiction

Localize a prebuilt scenario

Path 2 - Use a specific real jurisdiction

1. Select a prebuilt scenario.
2. Enable Use a specific real jurisdiction.
3. Enter a real city, county, tribal nation, port, state, or other jurisdiction.
4. Confirm the position/function and difficulty, then start the exercise.

WHAT LOCALIZATION CHANGES

NEXUS preserves the selected scenario structure while adapting the geography, agencies, resources, constraints, and local operating context to the real jurisdiction.

Building a Custom Scenario

Setup -> Preview -> Start

 **NEXUS EOC**
SIMULATED EMERGENCY OPERATIONS PLATFORM

BUILD CUSTOM SCENARIO
Setup → Preview → Start

Custom Scenario Setup

Brief NEXUS on the location, event, role, and training focus. NEXUS will turn your inputs into an EOC-focused exercise.

LOCATION / JURISDICTION
Philadelphia, PA
Use a real location. NEXUS EOC does not create fictional jurisdictions.

EVENT OR HAZARD
America's 250th celebration
Describe the planned event, hazard, or incident you want to train against.

SITUATION DESCRIPTION
Large national celebration with major crowds, federal and local coordination, VIP presence, transportation disruption, high media attention, and extreme heat risk.
Write this in plain language. NEXUS will convert it into a structured EOC exercise.

SELECT EXERCISE POSITION / FUNCTION
EOC Director
Role = who the user is playing.

SELECT DIFFICULTY
Adaptive
Difficulty controls tempo, ambiguity, friction, and consequence severity.

TRAINING FOCUS
Selected areas drive more injects, friction, decision points, and AAR feedback.

✓ Community Lifelines

✓ Resource Coordination

✓ Interagency Coordination

✓ Public Information

✓ Leadership Support

✓ Continuity / COOP

✓ Recovery Transition

Cancel

Generate Exercise Preview

Required inputs

Location / Jurisdiction Use a real location. NEXUS does not create fictional jurisdictions.	Event or Hazard Describe the incident, planned event, hazard, or operating challenge.
Situation Description State the starting conditions, known impacts, uncertainty, and EOC-level coordination problem.	Position / Function Choose the perspective from which the exercise will be played and evaluated.
Difficulty Controls tempo, ambiguity, friction, and consequence severity.	Training Focus Select the areas that should drive injects, decision points, and AAR feedback.

Custom Scenario Preview

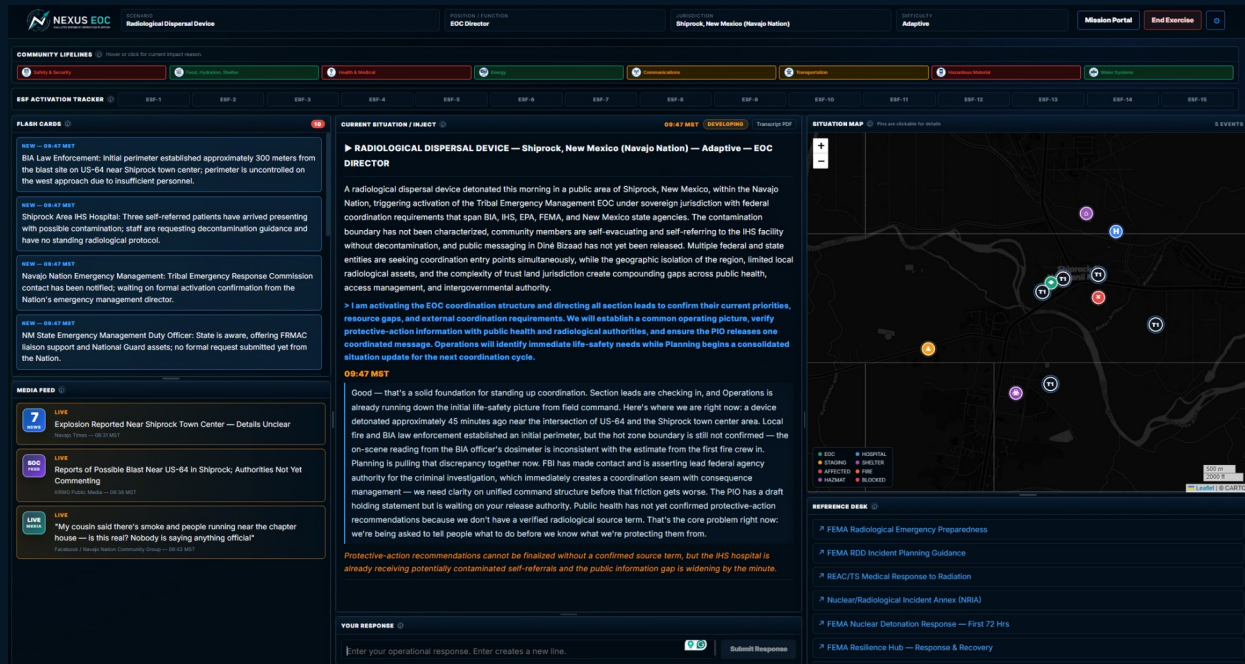
Confirm before launch

Preview before starting

- Confirm the location and incident make sense together.
- Check that the role matches the decisions you want to practice.
- Review the scenario summary and starting pressure before launching.
- Return to setup if the preview does not reflect the intended exercise.

Live Exercise Workspace

Read, decide, respond



Live Workspace Functions

Current Situation / Inject

Read first. It explains what changed, what remains uncertain, and where the next decision pressure exists.

Media Feed

Public pressure, rumors, visible impacts, and information gaps that may require PIO or leadership attention.

Community Lifelines

Shows impact to critical community functions. Hover or click for the reason behind each status.

Reference Desk

Doctrine, annexes, and response references that can help frame decisions.

Flash Cards

Reports from agencies, partners, facilities, and field elements. They add facts and friction without replacing judgment.

Situation Map

Incident geography, facilities, impacts, and new map events. Pan, zoom, and select pins for detail.

Response + Notepad

Submit operational direction in the response box. The notepad is private scratch space and is not sent to the AI.

ESF Tracker

A manual awareness aid. Toggling ESFs does not change the scenario by itself.

Writing Useful Responses

Operational language, not polished prose

A NATURAL EOC RESPONSE CAN BE MESSY

A strong response may mix questions, assignments, priorities, resource requests, planning assumptions, and follow-up actions. It does not need to read like a formal memo.

Example: direct, human, and operational

What is the weather and facility condition at the primary EOC? Has there been a federal disaster declaration?

ESF-8, confirm routes to the hospital and when the trauma team can move. As soon as conditions permit, deploy bridge engineers to inspect the bridges and have route-clearance teams clear the routes for them.

Have ESF-9 and the bridge engineers review imagery of the routes and bridges. Identify alternate ingress and egress routes from our disaster plans. First priority for ESF-9 is getting engineers to the bridges. Medical ESF, get the hospital online.

I want to know how many people remain in the evacuation zones, what critical infrastructure is without power, and whether helicopters can start flying again. Put a running Community Lifeline update on the large screen and show whether each lifeline is getting worse, improving, or holding steady.

Logistics needs to track deployed resources and order ahead of demand. Finance starts tracking expenses now. Request additional swift-water rescue teams, a DMAT for post-landfall medical surge, and mobile command vehicles for areas likely to lose road access. Shift contraflow assets to support route-clearing operations.

Call the neighboring county EM and get a clearer picture of what they need. Tell them once we are stabilized, I will see what support we can spare. Ask whether they received a FEMA IMT.

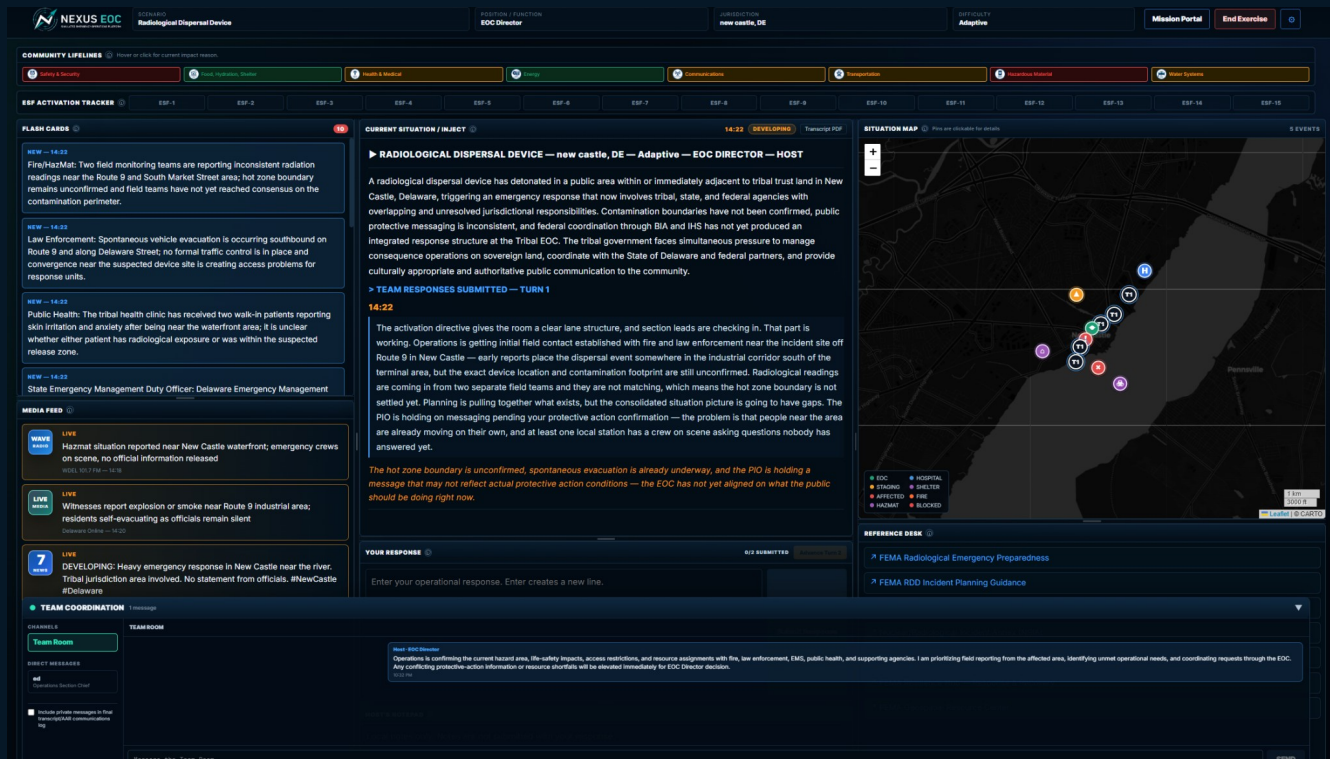
And most importantly, get another cup of coffee.

Why this works

- It asks for information without pausing the operation.
- It assigns owners and identifies sequencing: now, when conditions permit, and next.
- It links resources to an operational purpose.
- It addresses logistics, finance, medical, access, mutual aid, and the next operational period.
- It sounds like a real person directing staff.

Team Exercise

Shared play and coordination



Team Exercise live play with shared operational picture and Team Coordination drawer.

Host setup

1. Select Team Exercise and choose a prebuilt, localized, or custom scenario.
2. Select host mode: facilitator-only or host will play a role.
3. Enter the host name and role when applicable.
4. Create the Team Room and share the room code.
5. Confirm players have joined with unique roles, then select STARTEX.

Player join

1. Open Join Team Room and enter the room code.
2. Enter your name and select an available EOC role.
3. Review the scenario and wait for the host to begin.
4. Do not refresh or leave the room while a turn is processing.

Shared Turns and Team Coordination

How the room moves together

How a shared turn works

1. Players respond from their assigned EOC roles. Drafts and notepads remain private.
2. The response header shows how many active players have submitted.
3. When all active players are ready, the host selects Advance Turn.
4. NEXUS processes the combined inputs once and sends the same updated exercise state to every player.

Team Room Chat

Use the collapsible Team Coordination drawer for room-wide coordination. New messages create an unread alert when the drawer is closed.

Transcript Option

The host can choose whether private messages are included in the final transcript and AAR record.

Private Messages

Players may send one-to-one messages. Private messages remain visible only to the sender and recipient.

Advance Turn

Host-only. It becomes the primary action after all active players have submitted.

Player tips

- Ask questions, but keep operating. Do not wait for perfect information.
- Assign ownership. Name the section, ESF, agency, or staff function responsible.
- Sequence the work. Say what happens now, what happens when conditions permit, and what follows next.
- Use the tools already available: plans, imagery, lifelines, resource tracking, mutual aid, and agency coordination.
- Write like you talk in an EOC. Clear direction is better than polished prose.
- Track second-order effects: access, staffing, finance, logistics, public messaging, continuity, and the next operational period.

Ending the Exercise

AAR, transcript, and improvement


After-Action Review
Generated Aug 1, 2026



Radiological Dispersal Device

SCENARIO
Radiological Dispersal Device emergency operations exercise with realistic incident pressure, resource trade-offs, and cross-functional coordination requirements.

JURISDICTION
Tribal Nation operating environment with local capabilities, constraints, mutual aid considerations, and jurisdiction-specific incident impacts.

ROLE / POSITION
Senior emergency management coordinator responsible for cross-ESF coordination, resource prioritization, policy support, and strategic decision-making.

DIFFICULTY
Adaptive exercise pressure with realistic incident consequences and decision trade-offs.

PARTICIPANT	SCENARIO	JURISDICTION	ROLE	DIFFICULTY	LOCATION	SESSION	DURATION
Host	Radiological Dispersal Device	Tribal Nation	EOC Director	Adaptive	new castle, DE	H+0:00 to 14:22	2 turns

SITUATION SUMMARY

At H+0:00, a radiological dispersal device detonated in a public area within or immediately adjacent to tribal trust land in New Castle, Delaware. The Tribal EOC activated against a backdrop of six simultaneous pressure points: an unconfirmed BIA federal liaison, inconsistent radiological plume monitoring, walk-in patients arriving at the Regional Medical Center without IHS radiological protocols, state police unilaterally restricting a route crossing trust land, unchecked social media reporting of a second device, and Delaware EMA requesting a tribal point of contact before committing state resources. The exercise ran one operational turn to simulated time 14:22. By ENDEX, the EOC coordination structure had been verbally activated, field contact with fire and law enforcement near Route 9 and South Market Street had been initiated, and Planning had been tasked to begin a consolidated situation update. The hot zone boundary remained unconfirmed, spontaneous vehicle evacuation was degrading Route 9 access, the Tribal Health Clinic was receiving potential exposure patients without confirmed decontamination capability, and no coordinated public message had been released. The Delaware River surface water contamination pathway had not been assessed. The information environment was actively deteriorating with three media outlets running unconfirmed reports and no official tribal statement issued.

STRENGTHS

The EOC Director established a clear, ICS-consistent section structure from the outset and avoided the common pitfall of attempting to run tactical field operations from the EOC. The activation directive correctly tasked Operations to life-safety priorities and Planning to situational awareness, which reflects sound EOC management discipline. The Operations Section Chief demonstrated appropriate role boundaries - field contact without field command - and established a clear escalation protocol for conflicts and shortfalls. The cross-role communication between the EOC Director and Operations Section Chief in the team room showed functional coordination awareness: Operations echoed the Director's priorities without redundancy and added operational specificity. The team's framing of the PIO hold as a deliberate decision pending protective action confirmation, rather than an oversight, reflects messaging discipline appropriate to a radiological event where premature or inaccurate public guidance can cause direct harm.

CRITICAL GAPS

The exercise ended after one turn, so the team was evaluated on framing and intent rather than execution and consequence management. Within that constraint, the following gaps are significant. First, no jurisdictional lead confirmation was provided to Delaware EMA, which means state radiological resources remained blocked at ENDEX - this is a direct consequence of an unresolved sovereignty decision that the EOC Director did not address in the opening turn. Second, the federal coordination gap with BIA and IHS was acknowledged in opening dispatches but neither the Director nor Operations directed any follow-up action to resolve it. Third, the FBI's role as lead federal agency for the terrorism nexus of an RDD event was not mentioned or addressed. In an RDD scenario, the FBI had, first, Operations Center, and the

DECISION LOG REVIEW

The EOC Director issued a structurally sound activation directive: sections confirmed, COP tasked, PIO directed to hold for coordinated messaging, Operations tasked to life-safety priorities, Planning tasked to a consolidated situation update. The Operations Section Chief mirrored this with a disciplined field-contact posture, clearly delineating the escalation path for

Team After-Action Review screen with shared findings and role-specific feedback.

ENDEX choices

End with AAR

Ends the exercise and generates an after-action review. In Team Exercise, all players see a room-wide generating modal while NEXUS evaluates the record.

Cancel

Closes the ENDEX confirmation and returns to the live exercise.

End without AAR

Stops the exercise without generating an assessment. Useful for demos, quick checks, or incomplete practice runs.

Generation time

A Team AAR may take several minutes. Use the pause for a quick hotwash or short break.

Exercise Outputs

AAR, transcript, and downloads

What players receive

- Shared Team AAR: team decisions by turn, coordination performance, consequences, strengths, critical gaps, recommendations, and doctrine or reference notes.
- Individual Role AAR: private feedback tied to the player's role, submissions, timing, coordination contribution, strengths, and missed opportunities.
- Transcript: a chronological exercise record with player inputs, NEXUS updates, media reports, map events, lifeline changes, and permitted communications.
- Downloadable PDF reports for facilitated review, coaching, classroom discussion, and improvement planning.

USE THE AAR WITH THE TRANSCRIPT

Identify which decisions changed the incident, where coordination broke down, what information was missed, and what you would carry into the next exercise.